Biology Expert (PhD) — AI Safety

About the role

We're hiring PhD-level biologists to help make advanced AI models safer. You'll apply your scientific expertise to evaluate and strengthen how these models handle specialized life-science topics. No prior AI/ML experience is required — we'll train you on the workflow.

What you'll do

- Write expert-level prompts across specialized life-science topics.
- Evaluate and annotate model responses for scientific accuracy, helpfulness, and appropriate handling of sensitive content.
- Apply structured guidelines to classify prompts and conversations.

What we're looking for

- A PhD in biology or a closely related life-science field — ongoing or completed (e.g., molecular biology, microbiology, virology, genetics, biochemistry, bioinformatics, synthetic biology, immunology).
- Deep familiarity with modern laboratory and computational techniques in your subfield.
- Strong scientific reasoning and writing in English.
- Sound judgment around biosecurity and the responsible handling of dual-use information.

Nice to have

- Research or coursework touching on biosafety/biosecurity, pathogen biology, or gain-of-function considerations.
- Experience reviewing, grading, or red-teaming technical content.

Project Timeline

- Start date: Immediate
- Commitment: Part-time (15–25 hours/week, with flexibility up to 40 hours/week)

We consider all qualified applicants without regard to legally protected characteristics and provide reasonable accommodations upon request.

Contract and Payment Terms

- You will be engaged as an independent contractor.

- This is a fully remote role that can be completed on your own schedule.
- Projects can be extended, shortened, or concluded early depending on needs and performance.
- Your work at Mercor will not involve access to confidential or proprietary information from any employer, client, or institution.
- Payments are weekly on Stripe or Wise based on services rendered.
- Please note: We are unable to support H1-B or STEM OPT candidates at this time.